

Dry and wet AMD differ by neovascular activity

New haemorrhage or fluid changes the significance of a previously dry macular appearance.



Exudative macular disease: central haemorrhagic and exudative change in the source wet-AMD photograph.

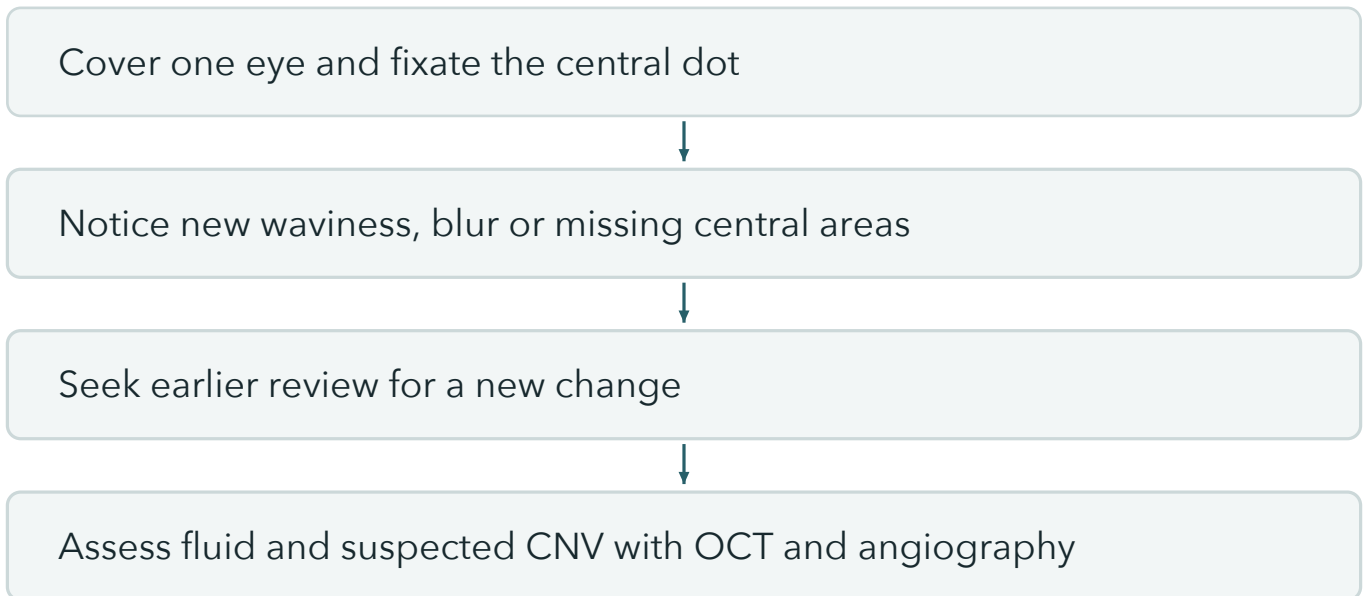
Clinical meaning

Dry AMD shows drusen and pigmentary change without active exudation. Drusen lie between RPE and Bruch membrane. Wet AMD involves choroidal neovascularisation and can cause fluid, haemorrhage and faster central decline. Describe these changes separately from the retinal new vessels of diabetic proliferative disease.

Investigate a change and preserve function

A new monocular Amsler abnormality should bring the review forward.

Respond to an Amsler change



Clinical meaning

Intravitreal anti-VEGF treats active wet AMD and may require repeated visits. Smoking cessation and vascular-risk control matter. Discuss appropriate antioxidant supplements; avoid beta-carotene in current or former smokers. A painless eye with new central distortion still needs assessment before the next routine appointment.